

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 301

By Pody

A RESOLUTION to recognize Sergeant Kevin Ragland of the Lebanon Police Department on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that the members of this General Assembly should honor those citizens who have performed with uncommon devotion and enthusiasm throughout their years of service; and

WHEREAS, Sergeant Kevin Ragland of the Lebanon Police Department is one such estimable individual, who has devoted his life to the preservation of law and order and the protection of his fellow citizens; and

WHEREAS, after an outstanding career in law enforcement, including seventeen years with the Lebanon Police Department and a total of twenty-two years in public service, Sergeant Ragland recently took a well-deserved retirement; and

WHEREAS, Sergeant Kevin Ragland graduated from Macon County High School in 1997 and earned a Bachelor of Science degree in Economics from the University of Tennessee, Knoxville; and

WHEREAS, Sergeant Ragland began his career with the Knoxville Police Department, serving from 2003 to 2008 as a police officer and field training officer; and

WHEREAS, in 2008, he joined the Lebanon Police Department, where he steadily rose through the ranks, from officer to field training officer, corporal, and sergeant; and

WHEREAS, throughout his distinguished career in law enforcement, Sergeant Kevin Ragland contributed greatly to his department as a bike patrol officer, K9 officer, meth lab technician, hostage negotiator, de-escalation instructor, and DUI instructor; and

WHEREAS, his numerous awards and recognitions include two Employee of the Month honors from the Knoxville Police Department, two Supervisor of the Year awards from the

Lebanon Police Department, and two Lifesaving Awards from the Lebanon Police Department;
and

WHEREAS, demonstrating his leadership and commitment to his colleagues, Sergeant Ragland served as vice president of the Fraternal Order of Police (Cedar City Lodge) from 2010 to 2014 and as that organization's president from 2014 to 2022; and

WHEREAS, his many accomplishments aside, Sergeant Kevin Ragland is most grateful for the love and companionship he shares with his wife of twenty years, Emily Ragland, and he is a devoted father of four children: Ruby, Houston, Jon, and James; and

WHEREAS, Sergeant Ragland exemplifies the spirit and allegiance to family and community that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, throughout his exemplary career, Sergeant Kevin Ragland performed his duties with the utmost professionalism, ability, and integrity, helping his fellow citizens in any way he could and proving himself to be a tremendous asset to the Lebanon Police Department; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH
GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF
REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor Sergeant Kevin Ragland of the Lebanon
Police Department on the occasion of his retirement, commend his many years of distinguished
service, and wish him every continued success in his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared
for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to
the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear
without House or Senate designation.